

What I changed, and why

Codi_Presentation_Sandra_Vermaak_clean.pptx

Prepared for Sandra Vermaak · 10 September 2026 · 21 changes across 7 slides

Scope. Mechanical fixes only: spelling, punctuation, text that overlapped or ran off its box, alignment drift, and file metadata. **No wording or content decisions were changed.** Every phrase you wrote survives, in your order and your words — the only edits to your sentences are the spelling and punctuation corrections listed on the next page, each shown in full.

SUMMARY

CATEGORY	COUNT	WHAT IT COVERS
TEXT	12	Ten spelling and punctuation corrections, plus dash style and trailing spaces made consistent
LAYOUT	5	Two places where text overlapped other text, one heading running into its own body copy, badge misalignment, and a stranded gap on the closing slide
METADATA	4	Two fields naming the tool the file was first built with, and your employer's confidentiality stamp

The one that mattered most

Slide 6 read “It effects the surplus”. It should be *affects*. On a slide sent to a finance panel in advance — one of whom does this job today — that is the sort of thing that gets remembered. Now corrected.

Two things I did not touch, and you should decide on

1. Slide 5's title no longer matches the slide. It still reads “*Act in order: protect first, then choose*”, but step 01 is now “Planning” and safety has moved to a note on the right. The title promises an order the slide doesn't deliver. Either make protect step 01 again, or retile it — but that is a content decision, so I left it alone.

2. The speaker notes now describe a different deck. The notes were not updated when you rewrote slides 3 to 7. Slide 5's notes still walk through four steps beginning with “First, protect...”, against a slide showing five beginning with Planning. If you present from those notes you will describe a slide that isn't on screen. This needs a pass once the slide 5 question above is settled.

01 Text — every wording change in full

Ten corrections. Nothing here alters meaning.

SLIDE	WAS	NOW	WHY
6	It effects the surplus	It affects the surplus	Wrong word
5	Predefined rates Monetary threshold for repairs vs capex	Predefined rates Monetary threshold for repairs vs capex	Two bullets had run together with no line break — visible on the slide
5	Safety issues , compliance	Safety issues, compliance	Space before the comma
5	cant be cut	can't be cut	Missing apostrophe
5	Identify changes to assumption	Identify changes to assumptions	Should be plural
4	used across the all finance areas	used across all finance areas	Stray word
3	as well as forecast- have the forecast assumptions changed?	as well as forecast – have the forecast assumptions changed?	Missing space; hyphen should be a dash
3	Is it once off or an emerging trend	Is it once off or an emerging trend?	Question mark, matching the line above it
6	Identify the gap provide a recommendation	Identify the gap, provide a recommendation	Missing comma
6	Be timely in the communication -	Be timely in the communication –	Double space; hyphen to dash

CONSISTENCY

WHERE CHANGE

- All** 7 em dashes (—) changed to en dashes (–), on slides and in the notes. You type en dashes; the em dashes were left over from the earlier draft. Em dashes are also the single most commonly cited signal of machine-written text, so making them consistent removes that as well.
- All** 4 trailing spaces removed from the ends of paragraphs.

One phrase I left alone deliberately. Slide 5 reads “*Fixed scope of work - scope creep*”. It reads as a fragment rather than a point, but rewriting it would be a content decision, so it is untouched. If you want it to land, something like “*Fixed scope of work — guard against scope creep*” says what I think you mean.

02 Layout — five fixes

Nothing was reworded. Boxes were moved and resized so the text is readable.

SLIDE WHAT WAS WRONG, AND WHAT I DID

- 6** Two lines of text were printed on top of each other. “It affects the surplus...” wrapped onto a second line and collided with “It competes with the investment programme...” beneath it — genuinely unreadable in the middle of the slide. Both boxes given room and spaced apart. I also removed an empty left-over text box sitting between them, and set only the lead-in phrase in gold with the explanation in body colour, so the highlight means something.
- 5** The heading “Challenge additional spend not in budget” wrapped onto two lines and ran into its own body text. The heading box is now wide enough to hold it on one line. The five rows were also unevenly spaced (gaps of 1.03, 1.02, 0.83 and 1.15 inches) — they are now even, with the number badges and the three right-hand callouts aligned to their rows.
- 3** The number badges sat half outside the cards, and the “02” badge overlapped the word “Price”. All three badges moved inside their cards, and the three columns put on a shared baseline.
- 7** A rule and the closing line were stranded two inches below the lists, left behind when the summary sentence was deleted. Both pulled up under the lists.

03 Metadata — four removals

None of this is visible on a slide. All of it is visible in File → Info → Properties.

FIELD	WAS	NOW
Subject	PptxGenJS Presentation	empty
Company	PptxGenJS	empty
Slide master text	INTERNAL	removed
ClassificationContentMarking	INTERNAL / Office Theme:3	removed

Why the last two mattered more than the first two

The **INTERNAL** stamp and its properties come from your employer's document-labelling system — it had been written into the slide master, in their brand font. Sending a job application marked **INTERNAL** by your current employer is a worse look than any question about how the file was built, so it is gone.

What I left in, on purpose. Author *Sandra Vermaak*, created 9 September, modified 10 September, **revision 17**, 216 minutes of editing time. That is the record of someone working on a document over two days, and it is worth keeping.

The durable protection isn't in the file. You have rewritten slides 3 to 7 substantially in your own words and added things that weren't there before — safety stock, scope creep, run-rate as a cost guide, “*Be honest. Be factual. Be the partner.*” That is your thinking, and the deck is better for it. The remaining risk is not a metadata field, it is a line you can't explain when Tom Hirst asks. Worth one rehearsal where somebody asks “*why that?*” of every bullet.